Note

- 1 is odd, its successor 2 is even and so its predecessor 0 is also even.
- The first natural number 1 is odd and the first whole number 0 is even.

2. Factors

Think about the situation:

The teacher gives Velavan two numbers 8 and 20 and asks him to write them as a product of two numbers. Velavan, with his mental math skills and also using the multiplication tables, quickly finds that 8 = 2 x 4; 20 = 2 x 10 and 4 x 5. From this, we can say that 2 and 4 are factors of 8 and also 2, 4, 5 and 10 are factors of 20. We can also write 8 as 1 x 8 and hence conclude that 1 and 8 are also factors of 8.

From the above examples, we observe that,

- **A factor is a number that divides the given number exactly (gives remainder zero)**.
- **Every number has two factors that is 1 and the number itself.**
- **Every factor of a given number is less than or equal to that number.**

3. Multiples

Look at the multiplication table of (say) 7:

1 x 7 = **7**

2 x 7 = **14**

3 x 7 = **21**

4 x 7 = **28**

5 x 7 = **35** ...

We say that the numbers 7, 14, 21, 28, 35,... are multiples of 7.

From this, we observe that

- **Every multiple of a given number is greater than or equal to that number.**

  Multiples of 7 are 7, 14, 21, 28,... . They are greater than or equal to 7.

- **Multiples of a number are endless.**

  Multiples of 5 are 5, 10, 15, 20,... . They are endless.

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